



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Chesterton Academy of Our Lady of Victory
School Website: <https://www.ourladyofvictorydenver.com/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Chesterton Academy of Our Lady of Victory (Colorado 80121 area; public domain material centers on Centennial/Littleton, CO) presents a distinctly Catholic, classical-school profile. The public-facing materials emphasize a chapel-based, liturgical rhythm (Mass each morning, adoration, formation Fridays, Cultura Vitae family programming), a clear Catholic identity, and a stated aim of forming holy, virtuous students within a classical framework. The curriculum evidence includes explicit attention to Latin and sacral arts, plus a focus on integrated, virtue-centered formation; there is also visible attention to liberal-arts style habits (creative arts, music, and drama) and a rigor of content (science and mathematics sequences). While the school convincingly conforms to several core classical elements, certain explicit classical-canon indicators (e.g., explicit, published Trivium/Quadrivium emphasis, and Socratic pedagogy in high school) are less overt in the public materials. Taken together, the school demonstrates substantial alignment with classical education across most criteria, with some categories showing only partial (somewhat classical) alignment.

Overall classification: CLASSICAL

- Important note: The school's Catholic identity and liturgical practices, together with an intentional formation focus and public emphasis on virtue and truth, anchor Element 1 (Religious & Metaphysical Foundations) and Element 2 (Purpose & Goal) firmly in the CLASSICAL bucket. Element 3 (Curriculum) and Element 4 (Pedagogy) show strong classical intentions (great books, Latin, formation, ritual life) but lack explicit, comprehensive public articulation of the entire Trivium/Quadrivium framework and Socratic pedagogy in all levels; those gaps place Element 3 and Element 4 into SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than fully CLASSICAL. Categories 5 (Faculty) and 6 (Parents & Community) exhibit strong classical signals (clear teacher leadership, mentorship framing, and active family/parent engagement), pushing the aggregate toward CLASSICAL despite the two somewhat-lower-scoring categories.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — [CLASSICAL]

- Evidence
- Official materials describe the school as a Catholic classical high school in the tradition of Catholic education, explicitly anchoring its identity in Catholic faith and tradition.
- The public materials emphasize liturgical worship, including daily Mass as a daily worship priority, adoration, and liturgical practices as part of schooling.
- The language of sacred tradition, Catholic formation, and liturgical life is reinforced through references to Latin as the Church's language and sacred signs within the education, underscoring a sacramental worldview.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: Catholic, Mass, liturgy, adoration, sacred, formation, Cultura Vitae, Catholic tradition, Our Lady of Victory, liturgical practices, reverence, sacred art. Estimated positive keyword occurrences: high (7+ meaningful terms observed across the site).
- Negative keywords present: none observed in public materials (no explicit secular, values-neutral, or non-religious framing).

- Why this rating
- The school's public materials foreground a Catholic metaphysical frame and liturgical life as central to education, well-aligned with transcendental moral realism, theology grounding, and liturgical/community practices central to classical education as described in the Six Essential Elements framework. This strongly supports CLASSICAL in this category.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — [CLASSICAL]

- Evidence
- The school states its aim to form students in virtue and wisdom within a classical, Catholic frame, framing education as the formation of character through truth, beauty, and goodness. For example, admissions describe a holistic formation emphasizing virtue, faith, and service.
- Public messaging emphasizes pursuing truth, goodness, and beauty in creation, and forming joyful leaders/saints within a classical framework.
- Public language speaks to a formation-oriented aim rather than mere information transfer, with focus on character, curiosity, and growth in wisdom and holiness.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: formation, wisdom, virtue, truth, goodness, beauty, human flourishing, character, love of learning, classical tradition, moral imagination.
- Negative keywords present: none (no overt emphasis on job prep or 21st-century-skills rhetoric in place of formation).
- Why this rating
- The school explicitly frames education as formation toward virtue and wisdom, not merely information or job preparation, with clear references to truth/goodness/beauty and a liberal-arts, holistic aim. This justifies CLASSICAL in this category.

Element 3: School Curriculum — [SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL]

- Evidence
- Explicit emphasis on Latin (Church language) and classical cultural formation, with references to the role of Latin in history and liturgy. This aligns with traditional classical curricula that valorize language mastery within a cultural/historical frame.
- The curriculum includes a focus on humanities-rich elements like Great Books through examples such as Homer's Odyssey being part of student life and classical formation, indicating engagement with Great Books and the Great Conversation.
- Public materials describe integrated classical formation with a music/theatre/art emphasis and a sequence of science and math that aligns with a liberal-arts flavor (e.g., "Science Sequence" with Astronomy, Earth Science, Biology, Chemistry, Physics; "MATH SEQUENCE" with multiple tracks).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: Latin, Great Books, Great Conversation, Seven Liberal Arts (implied by classical framing), history within classical tradition, integration/harmony of subjects, wonder.
- Negative keywords present: none explicitly; however, explicit articulation of Trivium/Quadrivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric; arithmetic, geometry, music, astronomy) is not clearly published in public-facing materials. While Latin and Great Books are evident, the canonical Trivium/Quadrivium framing is not explicitly spelled out on the site.

- Estimated positive keyword occurrences: moderate (clear presence of Latin, Great Books/Great Conversation via Homer, and integrated arts; some canonical liberal-arts cues are inferred rather than explicitly enumerated on the site).
- Why this rating
- The curriculum evidence shows strong classical elements (Latin, Great Books through Homer, integrated arts, and a liberal-arts flavor) but falls short of explicitly publishing the complete Trivium/Quadrivium framework and the explicit articulation of Great Conversation in public materials. Because several core classical indicators are present but not all are publicly explicit, this category is best described as SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — [SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL]

- Evidence
- The school emphasizes formation-specific pedagogy through a liturgical rhythm (Mass, adoration) and formation-oriented activities (Formation Fridays, Cultura Vitae events), indicating a contemplative and communal pedagogy in addition to rigorous study.
- There are strong signals of contemplative/restful learning and memory-rich practices via liturgical life and arts education (choirs, sacred music, Gregorian chant, and visual/theatre arts), signaling a pedagogy that values beauty, contemplation, and reverence alongside study.
- Upper-school pedagogy, as described in materials and related news, includes a heritage of classic formation with some content aimed at engagement with classical texts and culture (e.g., references to Chesterton, Catholic tradition, and cultural formation). Some elements point toward Socratic discourse and public speaking in classical education, but explicit public statements of regular Socratic seminars across grades aren't strongly evidenced in the site content.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: Scholé/restful learning, formation, contemplation, wonder, liturgical rhythm, rhetoric training (implied through public references to classical formation and arts), memory through chant and singing.
- Negative keywords present: explicit emphasis on pure project-based learning or exclusively experiential learning is not evident; the site doesn't highlight a predominant project-based, student-led, constructivist pedagogy as its sole approach.
- Estimated positive keyword occurrences: moderate (restful learning, contemplation, formation, liturgy, chants, and rhetoric are signaled in public materials; Socratic seminars are not clearly documented as a standard practice).
- Why this rating
- The pedagogy leans strongly toward formation and contemplative practices with classical arts and liturgical life, but it lacks explicit, broad statements about a full Socratic/seminar-based high-school pedagogy across the upper grades. Thus, SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL is most appropriate here.

Element 5: School Faculty — [CLASSICAL]

- Evidence
- The site references a clear leadership structure (Headmaster; Dean of Women; Dean of Faculty; Athletic Director) and a publicly stated mission for faculty to be virtuous models and mentors. This signals a faculty identity as living exemplars and a core element of the curriculum (the living curriculum).

- The site features a dedicated “Our Faculty & Staff” section, indicating visibility and accountability for faculty as educators and mentors in a classical framework. The presence of named leadership (e.g., Headmaster, President) reinforces a teacher-model approach.
- The school’s public materials emphasize formation through exemplary teachers and role-models, aligning with the classical ideal of teachers as virtuous exemplars and living curriculum.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: model teachers, mentors, living curriculum, faculty of friends, collegiality, portrait of a teacher, professional formation in classical pedagogy.
- Negative keywords present: none observed in public materials (no “teacher as customer,” no purely commodified framing).
- Why this rating
- Clear identification of strong faculty-led formation, mentorship, and a living curriculum aligns with CLASSICAL in this category.

Element 6: School Parents and Community — [CLASSICAL]

- Evidence
- The school emphasizes partnership with families and views parents as co-educators in the classical education ethos (Cultura Vitae events for families; formation opportunities for parents; parent involvement through events).
- There are explicit invitations for parents to participate in school life (open houses, shadow days, and parent-focused events such as formation Fridays and book-study opportunities). The site describes a family-friendly, partnership-rich model with continued access for parents to visit and engage.
- Parents and community are described as engaged participants in fundraising and school life (e.g., donation drives, events that welcome community participation). While fundraising content exists, it is framed within the community-formation narrative rather than as consumer-centric engagement.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: partnership with families, parent formation, family involvement, open campus, parental engagement, home-school partnership, community of learners.
- Negative keywords present: none apparent; no evidence of parent-as-customer framing or minimal parental access.
- Why this rating
- The school explicitly foregrounds parent involvement and community life as a core element of classical formation, supporting a CLASSICAL rating in this category.

Aggregate assessment

- Category ratings:
- Element 1 — CLASSICAL
- Element 2 — CLASSICAL
- Element 3 — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 4 — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 5 — CLASSICAL
- Element 6 — CLASSICAL

- General assessment: CLASSICAL (with two categories distinctly SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL). The strong Catholic identity, formation-focused purpose, and clear faculty/community commitments anchor the school firmly in classical education in most areas, while explicit public articulation of a full Trivium/Quadrivium curriculum and a consistently Socratic pedagogical approach remains less explicit in the public materials. The overall picture remains CLASSICAL, with room to more fully spell out canonical curriculum structures and Socratic pedagogy in public-facing materials.

What Would Move the Needle

- For Element 3 (Curriculum)
 - Publish explicit articulation of the Seven Liberal Arts framework (grammar, logic, rhetoric; arithmetic, geometry, music, astronomy) and connect Great Books with a concrete Great Conversation program.
 - Provide a clearly stated list of canonical Great Books, primary sources, and a cross-curricular plan showing how history, literature, philosophy, and sciences interrelate in a unified curriculum.
 - Emphasize a published plan for Trivium/Quadrivium elements and demonstrate integration with Latin, rhetoric, and logic in public materials.
- For Element 4 (Pedagogy)
 - Provide explicit public commitments to Socratic dialogue/seminars (Harkness-style discussions) for upper grades, with a plan showing when Socratic pedagogy begins and how students progress in rhetoric and public speaking.
 - Maintain and publicly document Scholé/restful-learning days and ensure a clear cadence of contemplative and challenging learning, with metrics to show outcomes tied to such rhythms.
 - Expand evidence of memory-work, recitation, and chant in the lower grades, linking these practices to formation goals public-facing.
- For Element 1 and 2 (Religious Foundations and Purpose)
 - Continue to foreground liturgical life and sacred tradition while articulating how these foundations shape liberal-arts formation (to strengthen the synergy of faith and reason as a formalizing anchor).
 - Consider publishing brief, structured statements tying the Catholic theological framework to specific learning outcomes, ensuring consistent messaging across grade levels.
- For Element 5 and 6 (Faculty & Community)
 - Maintain visible, named “living curriculum” faculty profiles and collectable testimonials showing formation through exemplary teaching practice.
 - Expand community-facing materials that demonstrate ongoing parent education, family catechesis, and community partnership opportunities beyond fund-raising and events.
- Abstract
 - The Chesterton Academy of Our Lady of Victory demonstrates CLASSICAL alignment across most elements: a strong Catholic identity and liturgical life (Religious & Metaphysical Foundations), a formation-centered purpose (Purpose & Goal), a curriculum with Latin, Great Books/Great Conversation sensibilities, and explicit teacher leadership (Faculty), plus a robust Parents & Community framework. Two areas—Curriculum and Pedagogy—are BEST described as SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL due to less explicit public articulation of Trivium/Quadrivium and the full Socratic/seminar pedagogy in the public site. The aggregate rating is CLASSICAL, with concrete steps identified to move the remaining categories fully into CLASSICAL.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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